Supply and Demand for Early Care and Education Services in North Minneapolis: Initial Analyses of Current Capacity and Use of School-Based Early Education and Family and Center-Based Child Care Programs in Zip Codes 55411 and 55412

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In Spring 2013, Ms. Barbara Milon and Ms. Carolyn Smallwood asked staff of CEED@UROC to provide assistance in describing the current supply and demand for early childhood care and education in North Minneapolis. This request was part of ongoing planning, conducted by various groups, to prepare for and expand capacity to provide access to high-quality early care and education settings for young children living in North Minneapolis through the provision of Early Learning Scholarships (from Race to the Top Early Learning Challenge Grant, Minnesota state-allocated funds, and/or Promise Neighborhood funds) – both those children living in and being served by the Northside Achievement Zone, and children living outside the Zone but whose families are also interested in accessing these high-quality services.

Kevin Overson and Scott McConnell from CEED@UROC worked on this effort, gathering and organizing information from several different sources. First, to describe the "supply" of early care and education settings, we gathered information from licensing, Parent Aware, and direct queries to school-based and child care programs (including center- and family-based programs) in and around Zip Codes 55411 and 55412 (two Zip Codes that cover much of North Minneapolis). These data include programs that are licensed and rated in Parent Aware (Minnesota's Quality Rating and Improvement System) and those programs not participating in Parent Aware. We were not able to gather information on Family Friend and Neighbor providers ("legal unlicensed" child care arrangements) in this area, but such providers are not currently eligible to receive ECD Scholarships, and thus are somewhat outside the broad intent of this analysis.

Next, we gathered information (with the assistance of Rob Grunewald from The Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis) to estimate the number of three- to four-year-old children living in this area who might be eligible to receive scholarship support to attend high-quality ECD settings. As part of this 'demand' analysis, we also gathered information from the Northside Achievement Zone regarding currently-enrolled children, and those currently receiving scholarship assistance.

We hope this information will be useful to program managers, policy makers, and advocates in considering the current state of access and quality in early care and education in North Minneapolis, and will serve as the basis for further data gathering, planning, and action.

Supply

To estimate the potential supply, and provide information that may be useful in organizing efforts to expand supply by improving quality ratings for already-operating early education programs, we have estimated the

number of programs and possible "slots" for preschool children in two North Minneapolis Zip Codes (55411 and 55412). As with any reports on child care and early education capacity, these data are quite "dynamic," meaning that numbers may well have changed from the time reports were generated, or programs may have changed status in that same interval.

Table 1 presents a summary of data provided by Sandy Myers of ThinkSmall, compiled from the NACCRRAWare, a comprehensive data base maintained by ThinkSmall and updated regularly with information on current openings; from Minneapolis Public Schools; and directly from providers.

Table 1. Early Care and Education Supply in North Minneapolis – Programs, Total Licensed Capacity and Currently Available Slots by Program Type and Parent Aware Rating

Program Type	Program Count	Total Slots Possible	Currently Available Slots
Parent Aware APR School Readiness Programs	11	472	10
Parent Aware APR Head Start Programs	1	Still being gathered	Still being gathered
Parent Aware APR Child Care Programs	5	255	24
Parent Aware 4-star	1	3	0
Parent Aware 3-star	0	0	0
Parent Aware 2-star	0	0	0
Parent Aware 1-star	4	36	8
Parent Aware Rating *Pending*	4	45	12
Licensed Center, NOT in Parent Aware	8	192	20
Licensed Family Childcare, NOT in Parent Aware	52	430	74
Total	86	1433	148

NOTE: Data from NACCRRAware, provided by Sandy Myers, Think Small, retrieved on 3/20/2013; Minneapolis Public Schools and providers, retrieved on 4/16/2013.

These supply data have also been presented on a map. That map can be found at
http://batchgeo.com/map/b9ee5139398424026fa9c485a0a1613e

Demand

To describe demand, we relied on estimates of the number of income-eligible children likely to be living in the two focal Zip Codes, with the assumption that these children would (based on current public policy and best practices) both benefit from enrollment in high-quality early care and education programs, and would be eligible for one or more subsidies for access.

Rob Grunewald of the Federal Reserve Bank provided these estimates. Rob noted that estimates may be somewhat low, because they are based on surveys completed between 2007 and 2011, and the population may have grown since that time. He also indicated that the US Census Bureau, the source of these estimates, notes that there is a relatively large margin of error – between 25-50% error at the 90% confidence level – for these estimates.

Table 2 presents estimates for the number of children who may be eligible for access support to attend high-quality early care and education settings in or near 55411 and 55412.

Table 2. Estimated Number of Children with Family Incomes below 100% and 185% of Federal Poverty Guidelines

	Number	***% of Total***
All Children 3-4 years	*1,553*	*100*
Below 100% FPG	*697*	*45%*
Below 185% FPG	*1,085*	*70%*

Note: Estimates based on US Census data from American Community Surveys completed between 2007-2011

Finally, we estimated the number of children already enrolled in the Northside Achievement Zone who may be eligible for scholarships, and interested in accessing high-quality programs in or near our focal Zip Codes.

Table 3: NAZ-Enrolled Children 3 to 5 Years of Age, and Those Currently Receiving Scholarships to Attend High-Quality Early Childhood Programs

	Number of Children
NAZ-enrolled children 3-5 years of age	109
NAZ-enrolled children 3-5, currently using scholarships	45

Note: Data provided by Karin Marida, Northside Achievement Zone

A few points to ponder

There are more than 1,500 3- and 4-year-olds in the 55411 and 55412 zip codes, and slots in 3- and 4-star-rated high quality early childhood programs for maybe fewer than half of these.

Using zip codes 55411 and 55412 creates an artificial boundary, as children and families do in reality cross these boundaries.

The data is old as soon as it's gathered; a more detailed analysis might be useful.

Other special populations, such as Homeless and Highly Mobile (HHM) kids, kids with disabilities, and new immigrants/English-language learners, are not specifically addressed.

Screen Print of Map of Supply, available at
http://batchgeo.com/map/b9ee5139398424026fa9c485a0a1613e

